

Troubleshooting ports

In case a port is broken, or you face issues installing a port, FreeBSD provides a Problem Report database where you can check if other users are also facing the same issue. You can then either report a problem or directly speak with the maintainer of the port and ask about the issue you are facing. You can also choose not to install the port and install the package instead.

Conclusion

The process of installing third-party applications on FreeBSD is not bereft of potholes. There is more than one step in which a novice programmer can falter, throwing the whole process into jeopardy. Hence, it is important to go over the basics of programming and work in FreeBSD thoroughly before installing something from outside the ecosystem.

In this chapter, we learned the various steps of installing third-party software in FreeBSD. The fundamental units of third-party installation in FreeBSD are ports and packages. Packages can be used to install a program automatically and directly without too many changes, while ports can be used if you want to make changes during the compilation process. We talked about how you can find software in FreeBSD and install it using `pkg`. We also explored the Ports Collection and the use of Poudriere to build packages. We then discussed certain post-installation considerations and troubleshooting. 